PROJECT HISTORY AND ARCHITECTURAL OVERVIEW

Building the New Just One Look Website

The journey from preservation and migration to one unified Zero, privacy-first measurement, and the All Roads Lead to Zero initiative

A concise record of the ideas that shaped the project

October 2026

The project in one view

The website grew in stages, but the central idea stayed constant: make the invitation itself easy to encounter, preserve the depth of the work, and keep the technology quieter than the message.

Stage	What changed
1. Foundation	A GitHub-based prototype established a durable home for the Method, documentation, and collaborative work.
2. Migration	The tested site became a simple static publication while the old site was preserved as historical source material.
3. Design	The homepage was organized around a human sequence: look first, ask What Now next, then explore the Library or Forum.
4. Launch	The tested build moved into the production repository and justonelook.org went live.
5. Zero	Two bounded AI guides became native website experiences, then evolved into one coherent guide for the complete Method.
6. Measurement	A private dashboard added aggregate, privacy-first traffic, guidance-delivery, and conversational-report signals.
7. Roads to Zero	Clean outreach URLs show which approved public roads are opened without tracking individual journeys.
8. Unification	The inward look and attention guidance now share one canonical Zero conversation at /try-it/.
9. Simplification	The retired SDA URL redirects to Zero; current measures lead the dashboard while former-guide data remains available as history.

The ideas that remained constant

- The invitation comes before explanation.
- The inward look remains the pivotal first act.
- The Library preserves source material; the Forum carries living conversation.
- Public pages should be calm, direct, mobile-friendly, and easy to maintain.
- Measurement should answer useful questions without creating personal profiles.
- The repository should preserve both implementation and reasoning.

Stage 1 - Establishing a durable foundation

The earliest work treated the website as an ongoing publication rather than a one-time design exercise.

GitHub provided a stable place to draft the Method, test themes and navigation, improve wording, and document how the work should be maintained. The site was becoming a long-lived public home for an active body of work.

Why GitHub suited the project

- History: every meaningful change can be traced, compared, and reversed when necessary.
- Safe experimentation: focused branches and pull requests separate development from publication.
- Continuity: instructions, design choices, tests, and maintenance notes live beside the code.
- Simple publishing: GitHub Pages turns the approved main branch into the public static website.
- Preservation: legacy material remains in the repository while staying outside routine publication.

> **An important operational boundary**
>
> GitHub Pages publishes the static website. Zero's Cloudflare Worker is deployed separately, so merging website changes does not silently redeploy the AI backend. This makes production changes deliberate.

Stage 2 - Migration without erasure

The migration phase took place in a test repository before the production move. Articles, books, recordings, videos, blog posts, and podcasts were reviewed and reorganized rather than copied blindly.

The historical site was retained under a dedicated legacy area and excluded from publication. The current website could become simpler without pretending the earlier website had never existed.

A clearer division of roles

- The website is the stable public publication.
- The Library is the organized home for books, articles, blog posts, podcasts, audio reports, and videos.
- The Forum is an external Discourse community for conversation.
- The legacy site is preserved source material, not part of routine publishing.

Stage 3 - Designing the visitor's journey

The central design decision was not a color or a layout. It was the order in which a visitor meets the work.

The homepage puts the inward look near the beginning. Explanation remains available, but it no longer has to be completed before the visitor can try the essential act. The What Now page follows naturally, while the Library and Forum offer depth without competing with the invitation.

The intended public sequence

1. Encounter the invitation to look.
2. Use Zero when direct guidance is helpful.
3. Continue naturally into attention guidance after the look.
4. Explore the Library for the broader body of work.
5. Use the Forum for community conversation.

The visual language supports this sequence through restraint: generous space, clear typography, a limited blue palette, the Just One Look identity, and Zero as a friendly guide rather than a dominant technical product.

Stage 4 - Moving into production

After review, the tested build moved into the production repository in August 2026. The custom domain, canonical URLs, metadata, sitemap, robots rules, social previews, and custom 404 page turned a collection of pages into a coherent public website.

The production repository became the canonical home for current website code and content. Focused branches, validation, pull requests, review, and explicit Worker deployments became the normal maintenance process.

The website today - short structural view

Area	Role
Root pages	Homepage, About, Contact, Forum, legal pages, and the main visitor journey.
library/	Books, articles, blog posts, podcasts, audio reports, and videos.
try-it/	The canonical public Zero guide for the complete Method.
self-directed-attention/	A compatibility redirect to /try-it/ for old bookmarks or links.
zero/	Canonical guide instructions, including preserved historical instruction sources.
worker/zero/	Worker backend, API routes, privacy-first measurement, tests, and deployment tooling.

Stage 5 - From two guides to one Zero

Zero evolved from companion Custom GPTs, through two bounded website guides, into one native guide for the complete Just One Look Method.

The earlier separation protected the inward look while each role was still being clarified. Looking Zero guided the first act; SDA Zero assumed the look had already been performed and taught formal and daily-life attention work. Their distinct instructions and measurements created a reliable foundation for unification.

The development then revealed a deeper continuity: looking at yourself and working with attention both use the human ability to direct attention deliberately. A single guide can present that relationship naturally without making the first look merely another exercise.

One guide, one movement of attention - one instruction at a time

- Zero gives the inward look priority and establishes whether it has been tried.
- A visitor who is ready can look immediately without completing an unnecessary preliminary exercise.
- After the look, Zero can continue into formal attention training and its practical use in daily life.
- Broader conversation remains possible, but Zero returns gently to the practical Method.
- The language remains direct and approachable rather than mysterious or guru-like.

Layer	Current responsibility
Instructions	zero/unified/instructions.md is the source of truth for the public guide.
Runtime	worker/zero/ serves /api/unified-zero with guide-specific limits, privacy, and measurement.
Public page	/try-it/ is the single canonical browser experience.
Compatibility	/self-directed-attention/ redirects to /try-it/; former backend records remain preserved.
What Now	The next-step page continues visitors into the same Zero guide.

Canonical public destination

Zero: https://justonelook.org/try-it/

Privacy and safety by design

- Conversations are sent to the OpenAI API with storage disabled.
- The site does not maintain a conversation database or user accounts.
- Origin checks, rate limits, message limits, and guide-specific boundaries protect the public service.
- No analytics cookies, visitor IDs, fingerprints, raw referrers, or linked visitor journeys are created.
- Canonical Markdown instructions, generated runtime modules, and automated tests reduce drift.

Stage 6 - Building a useful, private dashboard

The dashboard was created to support stewardship, not surveillance.

The project needed a way to learn whether people were reaching Zero, beginning conversations, receiving practical guidance, and reporting anything that might indicate they had tried. The answer was a private dashboard based on anonymous aggregate counts and tightly limited session metadata.

The current reading order

1. Website Traffic - independent aggregate page and action counts.
2. Roads to Zero - anonymous arrivals through approved source links.
3. Unified Zero - current guidance delivery and conversational reports since 20 October 2026.
4. Historical measurements - former Looking Zero and SDA Zero figures, collapsed by default.

> **Why history remains**
>
> The former-guide figures still document how Zero developed. Keeping them available, but visually secondary, preserves continuity without making the current dashboard hard to read.

What the dashboard does not show

- It does not identify a visitor or build a personal profile.
- It does not store conversation text, names, accounts, IP addresses, or browser fingerprints.
- It does not prove that an inward look occurred or that attention skills improved.
- It does not connect a source-road opening to a later Zero conversation or report.

The measurement philosophy

The design favors data minimization. A short-lived, one-way session hash supports limited operational measurement without preserving identity or message content. Older detail gives way to daily aggregates. Separate classifiers categorize limited milestones for measurement but cannot change Zero's reply.

How to read the figures responsibly

Use the dashboard to notice broad patterns, compare date ranges, and improve outreach or guidance. Do not turn aggregate counts into claims about individual journeys, success rates, or causal effects that the system does not observe.

Stage 7 - The All Roads Lead to Zero initiative

The initiative gives outreach a simple public vocabulary while preserving the project's privacy commitments.

Instead of long tracking links, each approved platform receives a short, readable address on justonelook.org. Opening that address records one anonymous aggregate source count and immediately continues to Zero at the canonical /try-it/ page.

Road	Public URL
X	https://justonelook.org/try-it/x/
Bluesky	https://justonelook.org/try-it/bluesky/
Reddit	https://justonelook.org/try-it/reddit/
TikTok	https://justonelook.org/try-it/tiktok/
Tumblr	https://justonelook.org/try-it/tumblr/
Pinterest	https://justonelook.org/try-it/pinterest/

How it connects to the dashboard

Each road has its own anonymous total for the selected date range. A road opening is not joined to a homepage view, Zero session, guidance milestone, or indication of trying. The dashboard can show how often a road was opened, but not what a particular person did afterward.

The privacy logic behind the roads

- No visitor identity is created.
- No cookie, fingerprint, referrer profile, or linked journey is stored.
- Only an approved source label and an aggregate daily count are needed.
- Additional roads or campaign slugs should be added only when a real public link is ready to use.

Why the source folders sit under try-it/

Keeping source routes beneath /try-it/ makes their relationship to canonical Zero explicit. Each source-entry page uses the same small privacy-preserving script and continues immediately to /try-it/.

Retiring the separate SDA page without breaking old links

After unified Zero was made public, the separate SDA page no longer served a distinct public purpose. Its traffic had been small, the guide had not been widely distributed, and the complete attention guidance was now available in Zero.

The public URL was therefore changed into a compatibility redirect rather than deleted. Old bookmarks and forgotten links still reach the right destination, while search engines are directed toward /try-it/ as canonical. The redirect itself creates no Zero session; measurement begins only when a visitor sends a message.

What was preserved

- The former Looking Zero and SDA Zero measurement records.
- The historical classifiers, tables, and backend routes needed to interpret those records.
- The source instructions and tests that document how the separate guides worked.
- The ability to understand the sequence of design decisions that led to unified Zero.

The resulting public structure

One canonical guide at /try-it/. One stable compatibility redirect from /self-directed-attention/. One current unified measurement section. One collapsed historical panel preserving the earlier record.

Stage 8 - Consolidation and the next phase

The production architecture now matches the conceptual simplicity of the public experience more closely.

Shared Zero styling and browser behavior use guide-neutral names. Canonical instructions generate the Worker's runtime module. Tests protect the first look, the transition into attention guidance, privacy boundaries, public routes, source attribution, and safe internal links.

What GitHub now preserves

- The published website and its stable public paths.
- The canonical instructions that define one coherent Zero guide.
- The Worker code, tests, measurement logic, and operational documentation.
- The Library and preserved historical website source.
- The reasoning behind privacy, measurement, outreach, and maintenance choices.
- A reviewable record of how the project developed over time.

The guiding principle going forward

Future work should continue to reduce accidental complexity without flattening meaningful distinctions. The first look remains central. Attention guidance should follow naturally when useful. Public URLs should remain stable and understandable. Measurement should remain useful but modest. And the repository should continue to serve as both the production source and the project's institutional memory.

In one sentence

The project has moved from rebuilding a website to establishing a durable public system: a quiet invitation, a preserved body of work, one coherent Zero guide, privacy-first learning, clean roads into the guide, and a repository that keeps the undertaking maintainable over time.

Current as of 20 October 2026